

Her Purpose, His Plan: A Woman's Journey with God

Chapter 1: Purpose in Childhood and Adolescence

"Before I formed you in the womb, I knew you, before you were born, I set you apart." – Jeremiah 1:5

Have you ever read that verse and just felt like it was speaking directly to you? I know I have.

Every time I read it, it hits me all over again: God had a plan for me before I even existed.

Before I could walk, talk, or even think, He had already mapped out my purpose.

Let that sink in for a moment—before anyone else knew you, God already did, and He had something special in mind for you.

And guess what? Being born a girl wasn't an accident. God didn't flip a coin or leave it up to chance.

He created you with intention. There were times growing up when I wondered if maybe He got it wrong.

Maybe I wasn't enough or didn't fit into the ***"big plan"*** as much as someone else. But trust me, He knew exactly what He was doing when He made you the way you are.

Who Am I Supposed to Be?

I remember being around 14—right in the middle of that phase where you're not a kid anymore, but you're definitely not an adult.

You're somewhere in between, trying to figure out where you fit.

I had friends who seemed like they had it all together: the super popular girl, the one who was always top of the class.

And then there was me, feeling like I was floating somewhere in the middle.

I didn't really know who I was supposed to be, and it felt like everyone else already had it figured out.

One night, I was lying in bed, staring at the ceiling, and it hit me—I had no clue who I was. It was kind of overwhelming.

My mind started racing with all these thoughts:

"Am I doing this right?"

Am I enough?

What does God even want from me?"

I talked to my mom about it the next day. She's always been my go-to when I'm feeling lost.

She said something that really stuck with me: ***“God made you exactly the way He wanted to. You don’t need to be like anyone else. You’re supposed to be you.”***

At first, I didn’t get it. I mean, how many times have we heard people say, ***“Be yourself”***? But as I thought about it more, I realized she was right.

I wasn’t created to blend in with everyone else. Neither were you.

God already knows who you are, and He doesn’t want you to copy anyone else’s life. He has a unique purpose just for you.

The Messy Middle

Let’s be real— being a teenager is chaotic. It’s confusing. There are days when you feel like you’re on top of the world, and then there are days when nothing seems to make sense.

It’s like you’re stuck between childhood and adulthood, and you’re not really sure where you fit. I’ve been there. I think we’ve all been there.

It’s easy to feel like you’re not enough or like you don’t measure up to what the world expects.

But here’s something I’ve learned: God doesn’t need you to have everything figured out. He’s

not expecting perfection. He just wants you to be open to His plan, even when it feels unclear.

Take the story of Esther, for example. She was young, probably around your age, and she wasn't born into some grand, royal family. She was just a regular girl.

But God had huge plans for her. He placed her in exactly the right spot, at exactly the right time, to save her people.

Esther didn't have all the answers, but she trusted God, and that's what made the difference.

When You Don't Know What's Next

So, what do you do when you're stuck in that ***"in-between" place?***

When you don't know what your next step should be, and everyone else seems to have it all figured out?

Here's the thing—you're not supposed to know everything yet. That's part of growing up.

God reveals His plan for us one step at a time, and sometimes, all we can do is take a small step of faith and trust Him with the rest.

Mary, the mother of Jesus, was young when God gave her the biggest responsibility ever. She didn't have all the answers, but

she said yes. She trusted God, even though she couldn't see the whole picture.

That's what faith looks like in these years. You don't have to know the end of the story yet.

You just have to trust that God is writing it, and He's got something amazing in store for you.

The pressure to have it all figured out is real, but you're allowed to take your time.

Each moment and each change is part of the journey. You'll look back one day and see how every little thing fits into God's bigger plan.

What Can You Do Today?

Here's the good news: you don't have to wait for some magical moment to discover your purpose. God is already preparing you for it, even now.

Here are some things that really helped me:

- **Daily Devotions:** I know it sounds simple, but spending just a few minutes with God each day can make a big difference. Open your Bible, talk to Him about your day, and ask Him for guidance. It doesn't have to be perfect, just honest.
- **Journaling:** This one was huge for me. Writing down my thoughts, prayers, and questions helped me process

everything I was going through. Looking back on those entries now, I can see how far I've come and how God has been working in my life.

- Find a Mentor: You don't have to figure everything out on your own. Find someone you trust—maybe it's a parent, a teacher, or someone from church—who can offer you wisdom and guidance. It helps to have someone to talk to when you're feeling unsure.

It's Okay Not to Have All the Answers

I'll say it again: you're not supposed to have everything figured out yet. God is still working on you, and that's a good thing.

The teenage years are all about growing, learning, and discovering who you are in His eyes.

As I look back on those early years, I realize something important: God's timing is perfect, even when it doesn't match ours.

We want answers now, but He's always working behind the scenes, shaping us for something greater.

The key is to stay close to Him, trust the process, and know that even when things seem uncertain, He's got a plan.

I didn't understand it at the time, but those awkward years of feeling lost, confused, and unsure of who I was meant to be were actually part of God's plan to help me grow.

Every experience, every moment of doubt, was leading me closer to understanding my true purpose. It wasn't always easy, but looking back, I can see how He was preparing me for the next chapter of my life.

And that's what I want you to remember. You don't have to have everything figured out right now. It's okay to feel uncertain—it's part of the journey.

Trust that God is with you in every step, even when the path ahead seems unclear. He's writing your story, and trust me, it's going to be beautiful.

I remember talking to a girl at church named Anna. She was feeling lost, just like I was when I was her age.

She asked me, ***“How do you know what God wants for you?”*** It was such a big question, and honestly, I didn't have all the answers.

But I told her this: ***“You don't have to know everything right now. Take it one day at a time, pray, and trust that God will show you the way.”***

So, as we wrap up this chapter, just take a deep breath. Know that you are seen, known, and loved by the One who created you. He's got you, and He's not in a hurry.

Let Him take you on this journey, step by step. You don't have to rush into the next stage of life—just lean into the moment,

grow where you are, and trust that in His perfect timing, everything will fall into place.

Summary and Key Takeaways

- God knew your purpose long before you were born.
- The teenage years are about growing into the person God made you to be, even in the messy middle.
- Esther, Mary, and other young women in the Bible trusted God with their purpose, even when they didn't have all the answers.
- You don't need to rush to figure everything out. God's plan will unfold in His timing.

Chapter 2: Purpose in Young Adulthood

“The future belongs to those who believe in the beauty of their dreams.” – Eleanor Roosevelt.

Eleanor Roosevelt’s words always remind us that believing in our dreams can really shape our future, even when we don’t know exactly what’s ahead.

When you’re in your twenties, it often feels like you’re at a crossroads.

Everything seems up in the air—your career, relationships, and even who you are. If this sounds familiar, you’re not alone.

I remember feeling this way myself. In my early twenties, I was trying to figure out my next steps.

I was torn between starting a career in accounting and going back to school for something else entirely. It felt like there were so many options in front of me, and I wasn’t sure which path to take.

I remember one afternoon, sitting with a friend at a café, and I was pouring out my heart to her.

“I’m not sure which path to take,” I said. “It’s like trying to see through a foggy window. I can’t even make out what’s on the other side.”

So, What Now?

I'll never forget my friend's response. She took a sip of her coffee, looked me straight in the eye, and then said,

“Sometimes, the best thing you can do is just start moving in a direction. You don't have to see the entire path to make a decision. Trust that God is guiding you. Your choices don't have to be flawless; they just need to be steps in the right direction. Just take one step at a time and see how it feels. The important thing is to start.”

That advice really stuck with me, and it was like that single statement saved my life from that moment.

When you're at a crossroads, it can feel like there's so much pressure to make the “*perfect*” choice.

But here's the thing: no choice is ever perfect. What matters more is taking action and seeing where it leads.

Life isn't always about making the right choice every time; it's about learning from each step you take and adjusting as you go.

How Do You Find Your Calling?

It's easy to feel overwhelmed when figuring out what God wants you to do, whether it's related to your career, relationships, or your role in ministry.

After my conversation with my friend that day, I decided to start taking steps, and I went to my Pastor for guidance. And what he told me felt very simple, but that was what helped me back then.

And here is what he told me

He said Aneta, When you get back home, I want you to think about what you love to do and what you're good at.

For example, if you're great at organizing and enjoy helping others, maybe your calling involves working with a charity or planning events for causes that matter to you.

If you have a thing for working with people and a creative streak, perhaps you can find a way to combine these interests in your career or volunteer work.

He went further to say

God often uses our interests and skills to point us toward our purpose.

It's like He gives us hints along the way. By focusing on what excites you and what you're good at, you can start to see where God might be guiding you.

When you're unsure, prayer can also be incredibly helpful. Talk to God about your dreams and concerns.

Ask Him to guide you and provide clarity. Prayer can help calm your mind and make the next steps clearer.

It's also a good idea to talk with mentors or friends you trust.

They can offer valuable advice and help you see your strengths and opportunities from a different perspective.

After my conversation with him, I began an operation, and I tagged it ***#OperationfindingAneta#***.

It was a little operation I put in for myself where I took six months to do all that my Pastor asked me and guessed what---worked.

Were there times when all the signs were saying it was on the wrong path? Of course!

But I always just reminded myself that God is my shepherd, and he is always there to guide me.

A few months ago, my niece Diane, who had just graduated from college, came to my place to spend some time seeking God's face and finding direction for the next chapter of her life.

Diane is passionate about both teaching and serving in ministry, but she was always stressed about choosing between these two paths.

I shared my own experience with her and suggested that it's not always about choosing just one path.

Sometimes, you can blend your passions in a way that works for you. We brainstormed ways Diane could incorporate her

love for teaching into her ministry work. She could use her teaching skills to support her ministry or bring elements of ministry into her classroom.

By combining her interests, Diane didn't have to choose one over the other; she could embrace both.

Finding your calling doesn't have to be about making a single, perfect choice.

It's more about figuring out how your passions and skills can come together in a way that aligns with what you believe God is calling you to do.

So, start with what you love, pray for guidance, and be open to blending your interests.

You might discover that your calling is a unique combination of what excites you and what you're meant to contribute to the world.

Trusting God's Plan

In the Bible, we find many stories of people who placed their trust in God even when their future was unclear. These stories offer us powerful lessons on faith and patience.

Take Hannah, for instance. Hannah was deeply troubled because she couldn't have children. She prayed earnestly, pouring out her heart to God and asking for a child.

Despite her ongoing struggle and the feelings of inadequacy she faced, Hannah didn't give up. She continued to trust God's plan and remained faithful.

Her prayers were eventually answered when she gave birth to Samuel, who grew up to become a prophet and a leader of Israel.

Hannah's story is a beautiful example of how trusting in God's timing, even when it's hard, can lead to incredible outcomes.

Another remarkable woman in the Bible is Deborah. Deborah was a judge and prophetess in a time when Israel was facing great challenges.

As a leader, she had to go through difficult situations and make tough decisions. Despite the uncertainty and danger of her time, Deborah trusted in God's plan and led her people with wisdom and courage.

Her faith and leadership were crucial in overcoming obstacles and achieving peace.

Deborah's story reminds us that even in the midst of uncertainty and adversity, God's guidance can empower us to achieve great things.

These stories show us that trusting in God's plan involves believing that He is working behind the scenes, even when we can't see the whole picture.

Just like Hannah and Deborah, we might not have all the answers or a clear view of the future, but faith means trusting that God is guiding us step by step.

What Can You Do Today?

If you're feeling stuck or unsure about your next steps, here are some practical things you can do to help find your way:

- **Pray for Guidance:** Spend time talking to God about your decisions. Ask Him for clarity and trust that He will lead you. Prayer can be a powerful way to calm your mind and get a sense of direction.
- **Set Goals:** Take some time to set goals that align with what you feel God is calling you to do. Write them down and break them into smaller steps. This will help you create a roadmap and make the process feel more manageable.
- **Seek Advice:** Don't be afraid to reach out to mentors or people you trust for guidance. Sometimes, talking things through with someone who has been through similar experiences can provide valuable insights and support.
- **Reflect and Adjust:** As you take steps forward, be open to adjusting your plans as needed. Sometimes, you might find that your initial choice leads to unexpected opportunities or changes.

Summary and Key Takeaways

- It's okay not to have everything figured out: You don't need to see the entire future to start making decisions. Just take one step at a time and trust that you're moving in the right direction.
- Trust in God's plan: Remember that God's plan for you is unfolding, even when you don't have all the details. Trust in His guidance and take steps forward with faith.
- Take a deep breath, and remember that it's okay to take things one step at a time. Each step you take is part of the journey, and God is with you every step of the way. Keep moving forward, stay true to yourself, and trust in the path that God is guiding you toward.

Chapter 3: Purpose in Career, Relationships, and Ministry

I remember reading a book by Joyce Meyer called *Living Beyond Your Feelings*.

In the book, Joyce talks about finding meaning and purpose in everyday life—whether it's in our work, relationships, or acts of service.

One line that really stood out to me was, ***“When we align our lives with God’s will, we find true fulfillment.”***

This really spoke to me because it reminds us that our careers, relationships, and ministries aren't just random parts of our lives. They're pieces of a bigger plan that God has for each of us.

But finding that purpose doesn't always feel easy. It can feel like we're walking through life, but we're not sure of the full picture.

However, by taking small, thoughtful steps and leaning on prayer and reflection, we start to see how the different pieces fit into God's bigger plan for our lives.

"Is This the Right Path for My Career?"

Finding purpose in our careers is something many of us struggle with.

We often ask ourselves, ***“Am I doing what I’m supposed to be doing?”*** or

“Is this job part of God’s plan for me, or should I be doing something else?”

Before we answer those questions, let’s remember that God works through us in all kinds of ways.

The job you have right now, even if it feels ordinary or unexciting, may still serve a bigger purpose.

But how do you know if it’s time to make a change or if you’re already where God wants you to be?

It’s important to pause and think about what parts of your work give you joy.

Are there moments in your job that make you feel happy or fulfilled?

Can you do more of those things in your current role?

Or maybe God is gently guiding you toward something new that aligns better with your gifts.

A few months ago, I had a long conversation with my friend Solene.

We’d been close for years, but life had been busy, and we hadn’t caught up properly in a while.

One day, we met up for brunch, and right away, I could tell something was weighing on her.

Solene: *I've been feeling really stuck lately. Like, I don't know why I'm doing what I'm doing anymore.*

She wasn't just talking about a bad day at the office. It was deeper—this feeling of dissatisfaction with her career that had been building for months.

Me: *What's going on? Is it your job?*

Solene: *Yeah. It's not that I hate it. It's just... I don't know if I'm supposed to be here anymore. I used to be so passionate about teaching, but now I feel like I'm just going through the motions.*

She sighed and took a bite out of her burger, clearly frustrated. Solene was one of those people who poured her heart into everything she did, so hearing her question her path was a bit surprising.

Me: *You've been teaching for years, and you've always loved it. Do you feel like something has changed? Or is it more like... you've changed?*

Solene: *Maybe both? I don't know. I just don't feel like I'm making the impact I used to. I feel like I'm not doing anything that matters anymore.*

Her words hit home for me because I've had those same thoughts before. It's easy to get caught up in the daily grind and lose sight of why we started doing something in the first place.

Me: *Do you remember why you got into teaching in the first place?*

Solene: *Yeah... I always loved helping people learn. Watching a student finally "get it" after struggling with something—that used to light me up. But now, it feels like I'm just ticking boxes and dealing with admin stuff all day.*

Me: *So, what if the problem isn't teaching itself, but how you're teaching right now?*

She looked at me, eyebrows raised, as if I'd just said something revolutionary.

Solene: *What do you mean?*

Me: *Maybe it's not that you're in the wrong career, but that you need to find a way to bring your passion back into it. What part of your job do you still enjoy?*

She thought for a moment before responding.

Solene: *I love the one-on-one time with students, helping them figure out how to approach something they're stuck on. But I hardly get to do that anymore.*

Me: *Okay, so what if you could make that a bigger part of your day? Maybe there's a way to shift things around. Or perhaps you could even start something new—like tutoring or leading smaller workshops that focus on that one-on-one interaction.*

Solene: *I've thought about it, but I don't know if it's realistic...*

Me: *Why not?*

She was silent for a few moments, clearly thinking it over.

Solene: *I guess I'm scared of change. What if it doesn't work out?*

Me: *That's understandable, but what if it does? You don't have to quit your job tomorrow, but maybe you could start small. See if there's a way to make changes within what you're already doing. Talk to your boss. Maybe they'd let you try something new.*

Solene: *You think?*

Me: *I do. But more importantly, what is God telling you? Do you think God's trying to nudge you in a different direction?*

She paused, reflecting on that.

Solene: *Maybe... I've been praying about it, but I still don't feel sure.*

Me: *Sometimes, we won't feel 100% sure before taking the first step. But if your passion for teaching is still there, maybe it's worth searching how to bring that back into your career.*

That conversation with Solene reminded me how important it is to pay attention to what brings us joy in our work.

Sometimes, God isn't asking us to change everything about our careers. Instead, He might be calling us to focus more on the parts that fulfill us.

Now, think about your own career. Are there parts that make you feel fulfilled?

Maybe it's helping others, solving problems, or creating something new.

Whatever it is, lean into that. It might even mean making small changes or considering new roles that better align with your strengths.

If you're unsure, seek guidance. Talking to a mentor, pastor, or even a career counselor can provide clarity.

Sometimes, we need a fresh perspective to see where God is leading us.

Finding Purpose in Relationships

Relationships are another area where we often seek purpose. Whether it's our marriages, friendships, or family, we want these connections to reflect God's love and plan.

In my own life, I've learned a lot about purpose through my relationship with my husband.

When we first got married, I thought I had it all figured out. But over time, I realized that marriage, like faith, is a journey.

It requires growth, trust, and constant reflection. The challenges we faced weren't just obstacles. They were lessons that brought us closer to each other and to God.

Through prayer, I understood that our relationship wasn't just about us. God was using our marriage to teach us about patience, love, and forgiveness.

Looking back, I can see that this was part of His plan all along, even when we couldn't see it ourselves.

I want you to take a moment to think about your own relationships.

Are they helping you grow in love, kindness, and patience?

Sometimes, God places people in our lives for reasons we don't immediately understand. If a relationship feels challenging, maybe it's an opportunity for growth.

Whether it's a friendship, family, or romantic relationship, prayer can provide clarity on how God wants to use that connection for His greater purpose.

Sometimes, we're called to heal and strengthen bonds. Other times, we might be led to let go, trusting that God has a plan even when things aren't perfect.

Finding Purpose in Ministry

Ministry is another big part of aligning with God's will. But remember, ministry doesn't have to be a formal role in a church.

It can be as simple as serving others in small ways—something we're all called to do as Christians.

One of the verses that remind me of this is Matthew 25:40:

“Whatever you did for one of the least of these, you did for me.”

Sometimes, we underestimate the value of the little things, but in God's eyes, even the smallest act of service matters.

For example, I started volunteering at church a few years ago. At first, I didn't think I had much to offer.

But I soon realized that ministry isn't about being perfect or knowing everything. It's about showing up with a willing heart and trusting that God will use whatever we have to give.

So, What Can You Do More?

I personally believe we all grow in purpose, whether it's in our jobs, relationships, or how we serve.

Anytime I feel stuck, and it seems I can't seem to find purpose in what I am doing, these are the things I do that I believe can help you:

- Pray for guidance. Ask God to reveal where He wants you to focus.
- Reflect on what brings you joy. Pay attention to what makes you feel fulfilled.
- Serve others. Even small acts of kindness can be part of your ministry.
- Be open to change. Sometimes, God calls us to step into something new. Don't be afraid to follow that nudge.

Here is a simple prayer you can pray right now if you seem stuck.

Dear God,

I come to you today seeking guidance in my work, relationships, and ministry. Help me to see where You want me to focus and how I can serve You better.

Give me the courage to step into new roles if that's what You're calling me to do, and help me find joy and purpose in every part of my life.

Thank You for Your constant love and guidance. I trust in Your plan for me, even when I don't see the full picture.

Amen.

Pray this continually, and take the time to reflect on where God might be leading you.

Ask for clarity and strength to follow His will, no matter where it takes you. He is your father, and it's his responsibility to guide you.

Finding purpose in our careers, relationships, and ministry is an ongoing journey. It's not always clear, and it can take time to see how everything fits together.

But through prayer, reflection, and small steps of faith, we begin to align ourselves with God's will.

Remember that God's purpose for you is already in motion. He's using your current job, relationships, and acts of service to prepare you for something greater.

Trust Him, and He will guide you.

Chapter 4: Purpose in Marriage

Marriage is a journey that can really change us in ways we might not understand until we're deep into it.

I remember a conversation with my mom a few years ago that really opened my eyes.

We were sitting at the kitchen table, enjoying our favorite tea, when she said something that really stuck with me: ***“Marriage isn’t just about sharing a home or chasing dreams together. It’s about finding a deeper purpose as a couple.”***

I went into marriage with a lot of expectations. Some were pretty realistic, but others were influenced by movies and fairy tales.

I imagined endless romantic moments and everything just falling into place. But as I settled into married life, I realized it wasn’t always that easy.

Marriage isn’t just about love and excitement at the start; it’s a journey of working together to find a greater purpose.

I remember talking to my mom about how things were going. I felt a bit overwhelmed with all the new responsibilities and routines.

My mom said, ***“When I was newly married, I thought everything would be perfect and easy. But I learned that real***

marriage is about partnership and growth. It's about finding how to support each other and work towards shared goals."

Her words helped me see that marriage is more than just a beautiful dream. It's a daily commitment to building something meaningful together.

This helped me understand that marriage is not just about enjoying each other's company or handling everyday tasks.

It's about growing together in faith and aligning your lives with God's plan.

When you're getting ready for marriage, it's an exciting time. You might be focused on the wedding details, like choosing the venue or the dress.

But it's also important to think about what marriage means in the context of your faith and how it fits into God's plan for your life.

It's not just about love; it's about working together to fulfill a higher purpose.

It's about aligning with God's plan and growing together in faith.

God's Plan for Marriage

From the beginning, God had a special plan for marriage. It's not just about finding a partner to share your life with.

It's about creating a bond that mirrors God's love and serves His kingdom.

Genesis 2:24 tells us, ***“Therefore a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and they shall become one flesh.”***

This verse highlights the essence of marriage—it's a union where two people come together to form a single, united front.

God designed marriage to be a partnership where both people support and uplift each other.

It's a reflection of His love for us—a love that is unconditional, patient, and enduring.

When we view marriage through this lens, it becomes clear that it's about more than just personal happiness. It's about fulfilling a divine purpose.

It's about walking together in faith, making decisions that honor God, and growing spiritually as a couple.

Marriage is a journey of growth and discovery. It involves understanding each other's strengths and weaknesses and working together to build a life that honors God.

As you face life's challenges and joys, remember that your marriage is an opportunity to reflect God's love and purpose in a very real and practical way.

How Do You Align Your Personal Goals with Your Spouses?

Aligning personal goals with your spouse's can be one of the most fulfilling aspects of marriage. It requires thoughtful communication and a willingness to adapt.

Let me share my own experience. When I decided to become a stay-at-home mom while working from home, it was a significant shift for both me and my husband.

We had to re-evaluate our goals and find a new rhythm that worked for us.

My husband and I began by having open discussions about our expectations and goals.

We talked about what we wanted to achieve in terms of finances, family life, and personal growth.

For example, we set a goal to save for a family vacation and decided on how to manage our household responsibilities.

We realized that balancing work and family required careful planning and cooperation.

We also had to adjust our financial goals and make sure we were on the same page about our budget and expenses.

It was a learning process, but by maintaining open communication and regularly checking in with each other, we were able to align our goals and support one another well.

This process of alignment wasn't just about logistics; it was about understanding and supporting each other's dreams. We learned that compromise and flexibility were key to making it work.

Building a Marriage That Reflects God's Purpose

So, how do you build a marriage that's grounded in God's purpose?

I have been married for over eight years now, and let me show you some of the things that have helped me and my husband grow together in faith:

1. **Set Marriage Goals Together:** Think about what you want to achieve as a couple. Setting goals helps give you both a clear sense of direction and something to work towards. These goals can cover various aspects of your life together, such as finances, family, or personal growth. For example, you might want to save for a special family event, work on improving your financial situation, or commit to volunteering together. Write down these goals and review them regularly to track your progress and make adjustments as needed.
2. **Have Regular Check-Ins:** Life can get busy, and it's easy to get lost in daily routines. To maintain a strong connection, schedule regular times to sit down with your spouse and talk about how things are going. This could be a weekly or monthly check-in where you discuss your

goals, feelings, and any challenges you're facing. Regular check-ins help you stay on the same page and address any issues before they become bigger problems. It's an opportunity to ensure that you're both aware of each other's needs and to work through difficulties together.

3. **Engage in Joint Prayer and Bible Study:** Spending time in prayer and studying the Bible together is one of the best ways to strengthen your marriage. It keeps both of you focused on God and encourages you to support each other spiritually. You might choose to read a devotional book together or set aside time each day for prayer. Engaging in these shared spiritual practices helps build a deeper connection and keeps your marriage centered around God's purpose. It's a way to grow together spiritually and ensure that your relationship remains aligned with your faith.

Guest Contributions: Wisdom from Women Who've Been There

I love learning from other women who've walked this path before me.

I asked a few of my friends to share their experiences, and here's what they said:

- Julie's Story (Married for 15 years): "One thing that's really helped my husband and I stay connected is having weekly check-ins. Every Sunday, we sit down and talk

about our week, our goals, and what we need from each other in the coming days. It's a simple practice, but it keeps us on the same page."

- Tina's Story (Married for 10 years): "For us, praying together every night before bed has been a game-changer. We take turns praying out loud, and it's amazing how that small habit has deepened our relationship, not just with each other, but with God too."

These are just two examples, but they show how little actions can make a big difference in keeping your marriage strong and aligned with God's purpose.

Summary and Key Takeaways

- Marriage is a journey of aligning with God's purpose and growing together in faith.
- Set clear goals for your marriage and review them regularly to stay on track.
- Schedule regular check-ins to discuss your goals, feelings, and any challenges you're facing.
- Engage in joint prayer and Bible study to strengthen your spiritual connection.

Marriage is about creating a partnership that reflects God's love and purpose. It's a journey of growth, communication, and shared goals.

By staying focused on God's plan and working together, you can build a strong and fulfilling marriage that honors Him.

Take time this week to reflect on your marriage. Are there areas where you can realign with God's purpose?

Spend some time in prayer, asking for His guidance and wisdom as you move forward together.

Chapter 5: The Role of Motherhood in God's Plan

“Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old, he will not depart from it.” — Proverbs 22:6

Motherhood.

When I think about it, the word alone carries so much weight, doesn't it?

It's one of those things that, no matter how much you try to prepare, there's always something new to learn, something unexpected.

I remember when I first became a mother with Damilola, my firstborn.

I had read all the books and listened to all the advice, and still, nothing could have prepared me for the reality of caring for this tiny human who relied on me for everything.

It was overwhelming but in the most beautiful way. Then came Grace, my second child, and I thought, ***“Okay, I've done this before; I've got it figured out.”*** but with each new child, the questions, the doubts, and the desire to get it *“right”* seemed to deepen.

One quiet evening, as Grace was just learning to walk, I sat down with my mother. We watched as Grace stumbled around the living room, her tiny hands reaching out to balance herself.

My heart was full of questions. ***“How do I make sure I’m doing enough?”*** I asked my mom. ***“What if I’m not the mother she needs?”***

My mother, always calm and wise, took a deep breath and said, ***“Motherhood isn’t about getting everything perfect, but about guiding your child with love and faith. As long as you’re committed to raising her in God’s way, He will make up for what you feel you lack.”***

Those words stuck with me. That night, as I prayed over Dammy and Grace, I remembered Proverbs 22:6. God was reminding me that while I had an important role in shaping their lives, it was ultimately Him who would guide their steps.

My role wasn’t about perfection; it was about planting seeds of faith, love, and purpose in their heart. This has been a guiding light in my journey as a mother.

What Is God's Plan for Motherhood?

When I look at the Bible, it’s clear that motherhood is a significant part of God’s plan.

From the very beginning, God designed motherhood as part of His larger purpose for families.

In Genesis, we read about how God created man and woman and told them to ***“be fruitful and multiply”*** (Genesis 1:28).

Motherhood isn’t just a biological role—it’s a spiritual calling.

We see this clearly in the story of Hannah, who prayed earnestly for a child.

When God blessed her with Samuel, she dedicated him to the Lord, trusting that he had a specific purpose.

Hannah's story always touches me because it reminds me of the responsibility we have as mothers to guide our children toward God's plan for their lives.

Like Hannah, we're called not only to care for our children but to help them discover their purpose in God's kingdom.

From the moment I had my first child, I felt this deep sense of responsibility. It wasn't just about making sure he was fed, clean, and healthy.

I knew that God had entrusted me with the role of nurturing him spiritually, helping him grow in faith, and understand his unique role in God's plan.

The same realization came when Grace was born. I knew that my purpose as their mother was to guide them both toward the path that God had set for them.

But here's the thing—no one ever really tells you how to do that. There's no step-by-step guide on how to raise children in faith.

Every day, you're figuring it out as you go, praying for wisdom, and hoping you're doing the right thing.

And let me tell you, I've had my share of days when I've questioned myself. But that's where God's grace comes in. I've learned to lean on Him every step of the way.

One of the books I read early on in my motherhood journey was *The Mission of Motherhood* by Sally Clarkson.

In it, Sally talks about how motherhood is one of the most important ministries we'll ever have. That really stuck with me.

As mothers, we're not just raising kids—we're raising the next generation of believers, the future leaders in God's kingdom. That's a huge responsibility, but it's also a privilege.

Helping Our Children Discover Their Purpose

The question many mothers often ask is, ***“How do I help my children discover their purpose?”*** It's not an easy question, but it's one we can start answering by being intentional in how we raise them.

I remember a moment with Grace that made me stop and think. She was about six at the time and came to me one evening with a question that caught me off guard.

Grace: “Mom, do you think God has a special plan for me?”

Me: “Absolutely, sweetheart. God has a plan for all of us. Why do you ask?”

Grace: “Well, I want to know what it is. What if I don’t find it?”

Her question was innocent, but it struck a chord with me. At that moment, I realized that part of my role as her mother wasn’t just to tell her that God had a plan but to help her discover it.

I knelt down to her level and said, ***“Grace, God’s plan for you will unfold as you grow. What’s important is that you stay close to Him, pray, and listen to His voice. Your purpose will become clearer over time.”***

That conversation with Grace reminded me that our children are already thinking about these things, even at a young age. It’s up to us, as mothers, to nurture that curiosity and guide them toward understanding their purpose in Christ.

And it’s not just about having these deep conversations. Sometimes, it’s the little things—like telling Bible stories before bed or praying together as a family.

These daily moments build a foundation of faith that our children will lean on as they grow.

There is a story in the bible that I love that reminds me of this situation, and it's the story of Jochebed, the mother of Moses.

She had to make a life-changing decision when she placed her baby in a basket and set him afloat on the Nile River to protect him from harm.

It was an act of faith, trusting that God had a greater purpose for her son. Jochebed's story shows us the power of a mother's faith and her role in guiding her child's life toward God's purpose.

Like her, we may not always see the full picture, but we trust that God is working in our children's lives.

Finding Purpose in Everyday Motherhood

One of the biggest lessons I've learned as a mother is that the small, everyday moments matter just as much as the big ones.

It's easy to get caught up in the idea that our purpose has to be something grand or life-changing, but God works through the ordinary just as much as He does through the extraordinary.

Sometimes, everyday tasks can feel repetitive, such as cooking meals, doing laundry, and helping with homework.

I used to wonder, ***"How does this fit into God's plan for me?"*** I wanted to do big things and make a difference, but God reminded me that even these small, everyday tasks have meaning.

There's a verse in Colossians that I often come back to when I'm feeling overwhelmed with the daily tasks of motherhood: ***"Whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men"*** (Colossians 3:23).

Whether I'm folding laundry, making dinner, or helping my children with their homework, I try to remember that even these seemingly mundane tasks are part of my purpose as a mother.

I remember one day, I was folding laundry while my son sat at the kitchen table working on his homework.

It was such an ordinary moment, but I felt a deep sense of peace. God spoke to my heart at that moment, reminding me that these small acts of service are part of my purpose.

It's not always about doing grand things; it's about being faithful to the little things, knowing that they all add up to something bigger in God's plan.

As moms, it's easy to feel like we're not doing enough, especially when we see other women seemingly achieving so much more.

But I've come to realize that the daily tasks we do for our families are just as important as any other role we may take on. When we care for our children, we're modeling Christ's love and service. And that is no small thing.

Raising Purposeful Children

I've learned that raising purposeful children doesn't happen overnight. It takes time, prayer, and intentionality. One thing I started doing with my children is incorporating Bible stories into our daily routine.

For example, before bed, we'll read a story from the Bible and talk about what it means. We discuss the choices the characters made and how God worked through them.

One story that always resonates with my kids is that of Samuel. As a young boy, Samuel heard God's voice calling him in the night.

At first, he didn't realize it was God, but after some guidance from Eli, the priest, he answered God's call (1 Samuel 3).

I often remind them that they, too, can hear God's voice if they're listening. It's these small moments, these little lessons that help our children grow in their faith and purpose.

I make it a point of duty to ask them how they're feeling about their faith. Sometimes, the answers are simple, and other times, we have deeper conversations about trusting God during tough times.

These check-ins help me understand where they are spiritually and how I can better guide them.

Another thing that's helped is making sure that our home is a place where faith is lived out, not just talked about. I've found that children learn more from what they see than what they hear.

When they see us as parents living out our faith—praying, reading the Bible, serving others—they learn to do the same.

Balancing Motherhood and Self-Care

I used to think that being a good mother meant giving everything to my kids and leaving nothing for myself.

But over the years, I've learned that self-care isn't selfish—it's necessary. You can't pour from an empty cup.

If I'm spiritually drained or emotionally exhausted, I'm not going to be the mother they need me to be.

One thing I've found helpful is setting aside quiet time each day to spend with God. Whether it's in the morning before the kids wake up or at night after they've gone to bed, I make sure to have time where I can pray, read my Bible, and recharge.

Psalms 23:3 says, "**He restores my soul.**" I hold onto that verse because it reminds me that God is the one who fills me up so I can pour into my children.

What Can You Do?

If you're like me, you might sometimes feel overwhelmed by the weight of motherhood.

But here are some simple steps you can take to make sure you're guiding your children toward their purpose while also finding meaning in your own journey:

- **Create a Parenting Plan:** Think about what kind of spiritual foundation you want to build for your children. What values and lessons do you want them to carry with them into adulthood? Write down a plan that focuses on guiding your children in faith, and revisit it regularly to see how you can improve or adjust it.
- **Incorporate Family Devotions:** One of the best ways to nurture your children's spiritual growth is by making Bible stories and prayer a regular part of your family routine. Whether it's reading a Bible story before bed or setting aside time for family prayers, these moments create a foundation for your children's faith journey.
- **Self-Care as a Mother:** Remember that you can't pour from an empty cup. It's essential to take care of your own spiritual and emotional health. Spend time in prayer, read the Bible, and seek out moments of quiet reflection to recharge and stay connected to God.

Prayers and Meditations

As we move through this journey, it's important to stay grounded in faith. Here's a simple prayer to keep in mind as you guide your children:

"Dear Lord, thank You for the incredible blessing of motherhood. I pray for wisdom as I raise my children in Your ways. Help me to be patient, loving, and faithful as I nurture their hearts and minds. Lead me in my role as a mother, and give me the strength to trust You with their future. Amen."

Reflect on Proverbs 31:28, which says, ***"Her children arise and call her blessed; her husband also, and he praises her."***

Spend some time meditating on how God sees your role as a mother and how He is working through you to shape the lives of your children.

Summary and Key Takeaways

- Motherhood is a sacred calling designed by God to guide and nurture our children toward their purpose.
- It's in the everyday moments of motherhood—teaching, serving, and loving—that we fulfill our purpose.
- Encourage your children to seek God's guidance in discovering their unique path, and lead by example in your own walk with Christ.

- Self-care is important for every mother. When we're filled spiritually, we're better equipped to guide our children.

Motherhood is a journey, one filled with both joys and challenges, but through it all, God is with us.

He is guiding us as we guide our children. In everyday moments, we find the purpose He has for us in this beautiful role.

Chapter 6: Purpose in Midlife

"For I know the plans I have for you," declares the Lord, "plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future." — Jeremiah 29:11

"Do you ever feel like you've done everything you were supposed to do, and now you're just...here?"

That question came from my friend, Ruth, during one of our many heart-to-heart conversations.

We were sitting together, sipping tea in the quiet of her living room.

Ruth's kids had grown up, and she was now facing that space where the busy days of raising children and managing a home had calmed down.

Her question hung in the air between us, and I could tell she was wrestling with something heavy on her heart.

"I think I understand how you feel," I said, nodding as I stirred my tea. "You've poured so much of yourself into your family, your job, keeping everything together, and now that it's settled, you're left wondering, 'What's next?' My elder sister went through this a few years ago."

Ruth leaned forward, her eyes searching mine for some sort of reassurance. ***"I just feel like I'm wandering," she admitted. "I've spent so many years giving everything to my family, and***

now, I don't know what I'm supposed to be doing. Is there even more for me?"

I reached over and gently touched her hand. "You're not alone, Ruth. My sister went through this exact same thing when she hit midlife.

It felt like everything she'd been doing—raising kids, managing her career—suddenly shifted, and she was left asking herself, 'What now?' But this stage isn't the end of your purpose; it's the beginning of something new. It's a season where you get to rediscover what God has in store for you moving forward."

We sat in quiet reflection for a few moments, both of us thinking about how midlife can make you pause and look back while also wondering what's ahead.

It's not always an easy time, but it is an opportunity to realign with God's plan.

Embracing the Shift in Midlife

As Ruth and I continued to talk, I shared something that had helped my sister when she was going through this stage.

"You know, my sister thought that once her children were grown and her career had settled, her main purpose had been fulfilled. She wondered if there was anything more for her to contribute. But she soon realized midlife isn't about reaching the end of your purpose—it's about renewing it. It's a time when God often shifts our focus. We're no longer raising

young children or climbing the career ladder, but there's still so much more God has for us."

Ruth listened closely, a glimmer of hope forming in her eyes.

"But how do you even figure out what that new purpose is?" she asked.

"It's a process," I said. "Midlife is a time to lean into God more than ever. It's about trusting that His plan is still unfolding, even if it looks different now.

I remember reading a book by Stormie Omartian, and she talked about midlife being a time to step into new roles we may not have considered before.

It's not about slowing down—it's about being open to the next steps God is laying out for you."

Ruth sighed, relieved but still thoughtful. "I guess I just worry that I won't see what those steps are."

"That's normal," I said. "Sometimes, God reveals things one step at a time. It might not be clear right away, but as you continue praying and seeking His guidance, you'll start to see the opportunities unfold.

I didn't plan on mentoring younger women at my church, but after praying and asking God to show me what was next, it became obvious that this was where He was leading me. And it's been one of the most fulfilling things I've ever done."

Finding New Purpose Beyond Career and Family

As we move through midlife, our roles change. We're no longer the moms rushing to school drop-offs or climbing the ladder in our careers.

Our identity begins to shift as children leave home or we retire from our jobs. And when those changes happen, it can feel like we've lost a part of who we are.

But that's where the beauty of midlife comes in—this is a season where God invites us to find a new sense of purpose.

I told Ruth about Julie, a woman from my Bible study group. Julie had spent years raising her children and working as a nurse.

When she reached midlife, her kids were grown, and she had retired from her job. For a while, she felt directionless, unsure of what her purpose was now that her life had changed so much.

But through prayer and reflection, Julie discovered a passion for mentoring young nurses. She began volunteering at a local hospital, sharing her years of experience with the next generation of healthcare workers.

What started as a small idea turned into a fulfilling new chapter in her life, one that she never saw coming.

“Julie’s story really showed me that purpose isn’t tied to just one phase of life,” I said. “God continues to use us, even when we think we’re done with the ‘busy’ years.

Midlife is the perfect time to ask, ‘How can I continue to serve God, even in this new chapter?’”

What Does God Say About Midlife?

We talked about how the Bible is full of examples of people who found their purpose later in life. One story that came to mind was that of Moses.

Moses didn’t even begin his most important work until he was about 80 years old. God called him to lead the Israelites out of Egypt, a massive, life-changing task.

In Exodus 7:7, it says, ***“Moses was eighty years old and Aaron eighty-three when they spoke to Pharaoh.”***

Imagine that—Moses spent the first part of his life wandering and unsure, but God had a bigger plan for him.

I shared this with Ruth as we talked about midlife. “Sometimes we think we’ve reached a point where we’re too old to make an impact or take on something new. But God’s timing is so different from ours. Moses is a great example of how God can call us to do important work, even in the later stages of our lives.”

“That’s comforting to hear,” Ruth said, a small smile forming on her face. “I guess I’ve been thinking of midlife as the end of something, but maybe it’s really the beginning of something new.”

“Exactly,” I said. “God still has plans for you. This season is about stepping into that next chapter and trusting Him to show you the way.”

Embracing New Opportunities

As you get to this stage, it’s important to stay open to the new opportunities that God places in front of you.

For many of us, the idea of finding new roles or passions can feel a bit scary, but it doesn’t have to be.

God often opens doors we never expected, and those doors can lead to some of the most fulfilling experiences of our lives.

I encouraged Ruth to stay open to the possibilities God was placing in front of her. “Have you thought about getting involved in a new way at church or volunteering in your community? Sometimes, God calls us to step into new roles that align with the gifts He’s been cultivating in us for years.”

Ruth thought for a moment. “I’ve always been good at listening and offering support to others. Maybe I could start a small group or get involved in counseling at church.”

“That sounds perfect,” I said, smiling. “God uses our natural gifts and experiences to create new opportunities for us to serve. You’ve already been mentoring people through your life—you just might not have realized it.”

Reflecting on What God Has Already Done

Sometimes, the best way to figure out what’s next is to look back on what God has already done in our lives.

As we reflect on the journey we’ve been on, we start to see patterns—ways God has worked through us in the past and how He might be calling us to continue that work in new ways.

I encouraged Ruth to take some time to reflect on her journey. ***“Look back on your life,” I said. “Think about the experiences that shaped you, the skills you’ve developed, and the lessons you’ve learned. What stands out? What are the things that brought you joy, that made you feel close to God?”***

By reflecting on the past, we can start to see how God has been preparing us for what’s next. We might find that the things we’ve been doing for years—whether it’s raising children, managing a career, or serving in church—are all part of a bigger picture.

“Think about Moses,” I reminded her. “He spent 40 years tending sheep before God called him to lead the Israelites. During those years, God prepared him for something greater. And I believe He’s doing the same for us.”

Staying Active in Faith and Purpose

It’s very important to stay active—both in our faith and in finding ways to serve God’s purpose.

This doesn’t mean we have to be as busy as we were in our younger years, but it does mean we need to stay intentional about how we spend our time and energy.

I encouraged Ruth to stay connected to her faith by finding activities that kept her mind and spirit engaged.

“It could be something as simple as taking a daily walk and using that time for prayer,” I said. “Or finding a new hobby that gives you peace and allows you to reflect on God’s goodness.”

She nodded, looking more at peace than when we first sat down. “I guess I’ve been thinking of midlife as a time to slow down, but maybe it’s just a different kind of active.”

“That’s exactly it,” I said. “It’s about being intentional in this season—finding purpose not in the busyness of life, but in the quiet moments where God speaks to us and shows us new ways to serve.”

Action Steps for Embracing Purpose in Midlife

As we move through midlife, it's important to take simple steps that help us understand and live out God's purpose for us.

Here are some things you can do to make the most of this season:

- **Take Time to Reflect:** Look back on your life and think about the experiences that have shaped you. Ask God to show you how He wants to use your journey for the next chapter. You could write down your thoughts, pray about them, and ask God for clarity on your next steps.
- **Try New Things:** Midlife can be a great time to try out new hobbies or interests that align with your purpose. Maybe there's something you've always wanted to do but didn't have the time for. It could be learning a new skill, volunteering in your community, or joining a group at church. Stay open to the new things God might be calling you to.
- **Connect with Others:** Find people who are also in the same phase of life. This could be through a small group at church or a community activity. Connecting with others can give you support, encouragement, and a sense of belonging.

- **Stay Active in Body and Spirit:** Make time to keep your faith strong by joining Bible studies, praying daily, or reading devotional books. Also, stay physically active—taking walks, doing light exercise, or enjoying a hobby that keeps you moving. Staying active helps you feel more energetic and connected to God’s purpose.
- **Find Ways to Serve:** Look for ways to use your life experience to help others. This could mean mentoring younger people, volunteering at your church, or supporting a cause you care about. Serving others is a wonderful way to live out your faith.
- **Set Goals for the Future:** Think about what you want to accomplish in this new season. Your goals could focus on your personal life, your spiritual growth, or your relationships. Pray about these goals and ask God to guide you in fulfilling them.

By taking these small, thoughtful steps, midlife can become a season of renewed purpose and growth.

It’s a time to discover new roles and continue serving God, trusting that He has a plan for every part of your life.

Key Takeaways and Summary

- Midlife is a season of renewal, not the end of your purpose. It's a time to reflect and embrace new roles that God may have for you.
- Stay open to God's calling, even if it looks different from your earlier years. There's always a new purpose in each season of life.
- Midlife is the perfect time to try new opportunities—mentoring, volunteering, and serving in ways that you hadn't considered before.
- Reflecting on your journey can provide clarity and help you see how God has been working in your life.
- Stay connected to your faith and seek ways to serve others, trusting that God still has a plan for you.

Midlife is a time of transition, but it's also a time of new beginnings. As we trust God and remain open to His plan, we can continue to live lives filled with purpose and meaning.

God's work in our lives is never done, and there's always something new on the horizon, even in this beautiful season of midlife.

Chapter 7: Finding Purpose in Later Years

"Do you ever think about what kind of legacy you'll leave behind?"

That question has come up in so many conversations with older women I've had. As I listen, I realize that it's one of the deepest questions we face, especially in the later years of life. When you reach a certain point, there's a shift.

You've already gone through the phases of raising children, building careers, and nurturing relationships, but now, you start thinking about the bigger picture—your legacy, your impact, and how your wisdom can guide others.

I've been reflecting a lot on this lately, even though I'm not at that stage yet. Watching older women in my church and community gracefully step into this new chapter of their lives has been inspiring.

I've come to understand that the later years are not just a winding down—they're about stepping into a new role, one that's centered around wisdom, guidance, and deep purpose.

What's My Role Now?

As we grow older, it's easy to feel like our most "productive" years are behind us, especially in a society that puts so much focus on youth and activity.

But from a biblical perspective, the later years are incredibly valuable. God sees our older years as a time for reflection, teaching, and leaving a meaningful impact.

Proverbs 16:31 says, ***"Gray hair is a crown of splendor; it is attained in the way of righteousness."***

This verse beautifully highlights the honor and respect that comes with age.

The wisdom you've gained through your life experiences is not just for you; it's for the benefit of others as well. The younger women in your life need your perspective, your stories, and your guidance.

You've walked the path they're just beginning, and your journey holds lessons they can learn from.

In the Bible, there are so many examples of women who found purpose in their later years. Think about Anna, the prophetess, in the Gospel of Luke.

She was widowed and spent years praying and fasting in the temple. When Mary and Joseph brought baby Jesus to the temple, Anna recognized Him as the Savior and began to tell

others. Her role wasn't just to observe; she played a key part in proclaiming the good news of Jesus. Her later years were filled with purpose as she mentored and shared her wisdom.

So, even though it might feel like life is quieter now, this season holds its own importance. It's a time to reflect on the legacy you want to leave and how you can continue to serve God's kingdom in new ways.

Passing On Your Wisdom

As I've talked to women who are entering their later years, a common theme comes up: the desire to share their wisdom with others.

If you're in this stage, know that your experience is a treasure that can shape the lives of those around you. The Bible says in Titus 2:3-4, "Older women likewise are to be reverent in behavior, not slanderers or slaves to much wine."

They are to teach what is good and so train the young women to love their husbands and children."

This verse outlines a powerful role for older women—to teach and mentor the next generation. You've likely gone through seasons that younger women haven't yet experienced.

You've learned what works in marriage, in parenting, and in maintaining your faith during difficult times. Your wisdom is exactly what many women are seeking.

Consider the mentorship opportunities that might already be present in your life. Whether it's a formal mentoring relationship or simply offering a listening ear to a younger woman in your church or community, your guidance can be invaluable.

I remember a woman in my church who started a small group specifically for young mothers. She would share stories from her own life, offering practical advice and scriptural encouragement.

The young women loved it because they felt supported and understood. That small group turned into a beautiful space where the wisdom of older women flowed into the hearts of the younger ones.

If you're wondering where to start, it doesn't have to be complicated. It could be as simple as inviting someone for coffee or sending a message of encouragement to a younger woman who seems to be struggling.

Your life experience can bring peace and perspective in ways that books and seminars can't. You've lived it, and that authenticity is what makes your guidance so powerful.

Leaving a Legacy of Faith

Legacy is a word that gets thrown around a lot, but when we think about it from a Christian perspective, it takes on a deeper meaning.

Leaving a legacy isn't just about what we accumulate or achieve in life; it's about the spiritual mark we leave behind. It's about how we've impacted others and how our faith continues to influence us even after we're gone.

For many women, the later years are a time to start thinking about how they can intentionally leave behind a legacy of faith.

Have you thought about what you want to be remembered for? Maybe it's the way you lived out your faith, the kindness you showed to others, or the time you spent teaching your children and grandchildren about God.

Psalms 145:4 says, ***“One generation shall commend your works to another, and shall declare your mighty acts.”***

This reminds us that our faith isn't just for us; it's meant to be passed down. Whether it's through your family, your church, or your community, you have the opportunity to share your faith in ways that will influence generations to come.

I once read about a woman named Elizabeth, who spent her later years documenting her faith journey for her grandchildren.

She wrote letters, shared her favorite Bible verses, and told stories of how God had guided her through difficult times. Those letters became a treasured legacy for her family, a tangible reminder of her faith and her love for God.

Her grandchildren now keep those letters as a source of encouragement.

Your legacy doesn't have to be written down, but it should be something you intentionally think about.

Whether it's sharing your testimony, starting a Bible study, or simply living out your faith in everyday life, the choices you make now will leave a lasting impact.

Living With Purpose, Even Now

It's easy to fall into the trap of thinking that as we age, our time of ***“doing”*** is over. But nothing could be further from the truth. There's still so much you can do, and God still has a plan for your life.

You might not be in the thick of raising children or building a career anymore, but that doesn't mean your purpose is over. In fact, this might be the time when God calls you to a new kind of purpose.

Have you considered how you can continue to live with purpose as you age? Maybe it's getting more involved in your church, volunteering in your community, or even starting a new

hobby that allows you to connect with others. The key is to stay active and engaged, both physically and spiritually.

I remember reading a book by Ruth Graham, where she talked about how important it is to keep moving forward, even as life slows down.

She said, ***“God has a purpose for each of us, no matter our age or stage in life. We are never too old to be used by Him.”***

That quote really stuck with me because it’s a reminder that God doesn’t put an expiration date on our purpose. He can use us at any age.

There’s a woman in my church who, in her 70s, decided to start learning to play the piano. It was something she had always wanted to do but never had the time for.

Now, she plays during our church services, and it’s become a beautiful way for her to serve God and the congregation.

Her story reminds me that it’s never too late to try something new or to step into a new role. God’s purpose for our lives doesn’t stop just because we’re older—it simply shifts.

Action Steps for Living with Purpose in Later Years

As you reflect on this stage of life, here are a few steps you can take to continue living with purpose:

- **Legacy Planning:** Take time to think about the kind of legacy you want to leave behind. This could be writing down your testimony, sharing your faith with your family, or starting a ministry that reflects your life's journey.
- **Mentorship Opportunities:** Look for ways to mentor younger women in your church or community. Your wisdom and experience can guide them through the challenges they're facing.
- **Stay Active in Faith:** Continue to participate in church and community activities. Whether it's volunteering, teaching, or simply offering support to others, staying involved keeps you connected to your purpose.
- **Try New Interests:** Don't be afraid to try something new. Whether it's a hobby, a skill, or a new way of serving, this is a great time to explore the interests that God has placed in your heart.

Summary and Key Takeaways

- Your later years are a time to reflect, mentor, and leave a legacy of faith.
- Mentoring younger women and sharing your wisdom is a valuable way to live out your purpose.
- God's purpose for your life doesn't end as you age—it shifts, giving you new ways to serve Him.
- Stay active and engaged, both physically and spiritually, as you continue to seek out new opportunities for growth.

God has a plan for every season of life, and the later years are no exception. By embracing this stage and finding new ways to serve and share your faith, you can continue to live a life filled with meaning and purpose.

The legacy you leave behind will reflect the life you lived—a life grounded in God's love and His plan for you.

Chapter 8: The Core of Purpose – A Life Centered on God

"Seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well." — Matthew 6:33

When I first truly understood Matthew 6:33, it changed how I saw my relationship with God.

I had always known I should put God first, but knowing and living it out are two different things. It's easy for life to get busy.

Between family, work, and everything else we juggle, keeping God at the center can sometimes feel like just another task on a long to-do list.

But the more I thought about it, the more I realized that everything in my life—every role, every relationship—flows better when God is at the center.

My relationships, my career, my dreams—none of them make sense when God is not the foundation.

I remember a time when I was juggling so many responsibilities, trying to manage everything on my own strength.

I felt like I was being pulled in a thousand different directions.

One evening, I was talking to a mentor of mine, and she told me something simple yet powerful: ***"When God is the core,***

everything else starts to align—not always perfectly, but in a way that brings peace.”

That conversation struck me because I realized I had been trying to hold everything together myself. The more I tried, the more I felt disconnected and out of balance.

But when I started making an effort to center my day around God—through prayer, quiet reflection, and surrender—things began to change.

It wasn't that my problems magically disappeared, but my perspective shifted. I wasn't carrying everything on my own anymore; I was leaning on God's strength.

What Does It Mean to Keep God First?

There's a difference between including God in your life and making Him the foundation of everything.

When God is at the center, all aspects of your life—your family, your work, your dreams—start to fall into place. But when God is just one part of your life, things can feel disjointed and overwhelming.

I remember a season in my life where I was constantly busy. I was doing good things—working, taking care of my family, volunteering—but I wasn't making time for God.

I'd tell myself I'd pray later or that I'd spend time reading the Bible tomorrow. Before I knew it, those ***“tomorrows”*** turned

into weeks. My soul felt tired, and I couldn't quite figure out why.

I decided to take a step back and re-evaluate. That's when I realized I had been trying to carry everything without really connecting with the One who gives me strength. So, I started making prayer a priority again.

Every morning, even if just for a few minutes, I'd pray and reflect on scripture. And it made all the difference.

My days didn't suddenly become easy, but they were filled with more peace because I had made space for God at the center.

Worship Through Our Daily Lives

Worship is so much more than the songs we sing on Sundays at church. It's a way of life.

Worship means honoring God in everything we do—how we serve others, how we treat those around us, how we work, and how we show kindness.

Paul reminds us in Romans 12:1 to ***“offer your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God—this is your true and proper worship.”***

In other words, every moment of our lives can be an act of worship when it's done for God's glory.

I've found that one of the best ways to keep God at the center of my life is through service. Serving others is a powerful way to live out our purpose, as it reflects God's heart.

Whether it's something big like volunteering at church or something as simple as offering a kind word to someone in need, these acts of service remind us of the bigger picture. It's about showing God's love in practical ways.

I'll never forget a time when I volunteered at a community food pantry. At first, it seemed like another item on my list of things to do.

But as I started to serve regularly, I realized that it wasn't about me at all. The more I helped others, the more I began to feel connected to God's purpose for my life.

Serving wasn't just an obligation—it became a form of worship. In the simple act of helping others, I was showing God's love in a tangible way, and it changed my perspective on what true purpose looks like.

Service teaches us that our purpose isn't always about doing grand things.

Sometimes, our greatest acts of worship come from the simplest gestures—caring for our family, being a good listener, or helping someone in need.

It's about honoring God in our lives, even in the ordinary moments.

Growing Closer to God

A relationship with God is like any other relationship—it requires time, effort, and consistency. The more time we spend with Him, the more we align ourselves with His purpose.

But it doesn't happen automatically. Just like in a friendship, you need to invest in your connection with God.

I remember a close friend telling me how she managed to stay connected to God despite her busy schedule.

Every morning, she would wake up early, make her coffee, and sit with her Bible for 35 minutes before anyone else in the house was awake.

She called it her “Quiet time” with God, and it was something she never compromised on. That time of prayer and reflection grounded her for the rest of the day, no matter what challenges came her way.

Her dedication inspired me to create my own quiet time with God. I learned that you don't have to have an hour of deep study every day; sometimes, it's just a few moments of intentional prayer or reading a scripture that carries you through the day.

It's about building a habit that keeps you connected to God. The more you invest in your relationship with Him, the more your life aligns with His purpose.

Thinking on God's Purpose for Your Life

As we strive to keep God at the center of our lives, it's important to take time to reflect on how He's worked in our lives up to this point.

Sometimes, in the rush of everyday life, we forget to look back and see how faithful God has been. But when we pause and reflect, we start to see patterns—ways that God has been guiding us all along, even when we didn't realize it.

One of the ways I've found helpful in reflecting on God's work in my life is by keeping a journal. I'll jot down prayers, thoughts, or even small moments where I've seen God at work.

Over time, those entries serve as reminders of God's faithfulness. When I'm feeling uncertain or overwhelmed, I can look back and see how God has always provided, always guided, and always been present, even in the most challenging seasons.

This reflection brings to mind Jeremiah 29:11, one of my favorite verses: "For I know the plans I have for you," declares the Lord, "plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future."

This verse reminds me that no matter what season of life I'm in, God's plan for me is good. He knows what's ahead, and I can trust Him to guide me through each step.

How to Keep God at the Center

Living a life centered on God doesn't require huge, dramatic changes.

Often, it's the small, consistent habits that keep us grounded in our faith. Here are a few practical ways to keep God at the center of your life:

- **Start Your Day with Prayer:** Dedicate the first moments of your day to God. Whether it's a simple "thank you" or a longer prayer for guidance, beginning your day with God helps set the tone for everything else.
- **Read Scripture Regularly:** Make it a habit to spend time in God's Word each day. Even if it's just a few verses, let the Bible guide your thoughts and actions.
- **Find Ways to Serve:** Look for opportunities to serve others. Whether it's through your church, your community, or even within your own family, service is a powerful way to live out your faith.
- **Reflect on Gratitude:** Take time each day to reflect on the things you're grateful for. This simple practice shifts your focus from life's challenges to God's blessings.

- **Worship in Every Moment:** Remember that worship isn't just something we do on Sundays. We can worship God in the way we live our lives—by treating others with kindness, working with integrity, and being mindful of His presence in everything we do.

Key Takeaways and Summary

- Keeping God at the center brings peace and purpose to all areas of our lives.
- Worship is about how we live our lives, not just what happens in church.
- Service is a powerful way to live out our purpose and honor God.
- Building a strong relationship with God requires time, effort, and consistency.
- Reflecting on God's past faithfulness helps us trust Him for the future.

By taking these steps and making God the foundation of everything we do, we can live a life that's not only meaningful but also centered on His will and purpose for us.

Each day becomes an opportunity to grow closer to God, serve others, and live out the purpose He's placed on our hearts.